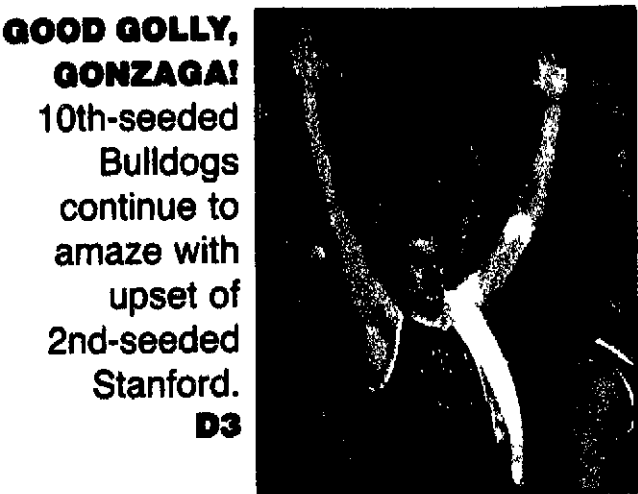




GOOD GOLLY, GONZAGA!
10th-seeded Bulldogs continue to amaze with upset of 2nd-seeded Stanford. D3

NCAA WOMEN

Toledo, Ohio State fall in first round. D2

CHRIS ASSENHEIMER

Indians 3-7? Aw, it's only spring training. D8

SCOTT PETRAK

Avon grad Vega has up-and-down season. D4

Sports

The Chronicle / SUNDAY, MARCH 14, 1999 D1

Cavs fall short

Michael A. Lutz
Associated Press

HOUSTON — Hakeem Olajuwon got the Houston Rockets going early and Scottie Pippen took over for him in the second half.

Olajuwon continued his resurgence with 24 points, 15 in the first half, and Pippen scored 15 of his 16 points in the second half as the Houston Rockets escaped with a 100-89 victory over the Cleveland Cavaliers Saturday night.

"Our game plan was to go inside and when the double and triple teams come, take what the defense will give you," Olajuwon said. "I'm progressing as the season progresses and I'm feeling more comfortable."

The Rockets built a 54-36 half-time lead on a strong start by Olajuwon but for the second consecutive game, the Rockets couldn't put its opponent away. The Rockets had a big lead against Vancouver on Thursday before struggling to a 102-91 victory.

Olajuwon, who struggled at the beginning of the season, has averaged 25.2 points over the past four games. Over those four games, Olajuwon has hit 56 percent from the field.

"I thought we did a very good job of executing our offense when they were double-teaming," Rockets coach Rudy Tomjanovich said. "We made the outside shots, but we also swung the ball around the horn and got a mismatch on the weak side."

Cedric Henderson hit Cleveland's first three baskets of the third quarter and led a 16-5 spurt that cut Houston's lead to 59-52 with 7:32 left in the quarter.

The Rockets never trailed but Cleveland got within four points twice, the last at 84-80 with 5:53 to play on a basket by Bob Sura.

"I'm happy the way we bounced back in the second half," Cavaliers coach Mike Fratello said. "We got it down to four point but every time we got it down to that it seemed like Scottie came up with a big play and we wouldn't get over the hump."

With Houston leading by 84-80, Brent Price hit a 3-pointer and two free throws and Cuttino Mobley's shot made it 91-80 for the Rockets.

"It was still a very disappointing game on our part," Pippen said. "I felt we sort of cheated our bench. This was a game which we should have taken care of early, but we just didn't come out and play the second half the way we should have. It was just a poor

See **CAVS**, D9



AP

NOT THIS TIME: Ohio State's Jason Singleton (23) blocks the shot of Detroit's Bacari Alexander during Saturday's NCAA South Regional game in Indianapolis.

Take that, Titans

Buckeyes beat Detroit, will face top seed Auburn

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

INDIANAPOLIS, Ind. — Ohio State gave the defensive club a large dose of its own medicine Saturday.

The University of Detroit was hoisted by its own petard, so to speak.

The Titans, who came into Saturday's NCAA second round at the RCA Dome as the nation's second-leading defensive club, were totally frustrated and shut down by the Buckeyes.

"We just played outstanding defense," said Ohio State coach Jim O'Brien after the Buckeyes routed the Titans 75-44 before 32,758, most of them OSU fans.

"Neither team did really well on offense in the first half, but we continued to play fine defense in the second half."

OSU shooters come alive in second half. D2.

"When you combine that with an efficient offensive performance in the second half, you get this kind of result."

Ohio State, 25-8, seeded fourth in the South Region, will play top-seeded Auburn in the Sweet Sixteen Thursday in Knoxville, Tenn.

Defense and rebounding are the seeds that sprouted into Detroit's ruin. The Titans, 25-6, champions of the Midwestern Collegiate Conference, missed their first 13 shots and didn't score until the first half was nearly half gone.

Ohio State wasn't burning the nets either and held just a 12-0 lead.

See **BUCKEYES**, D9



ON PAGE D3

SOUTH REGIONAL

■ Auburn guard scores career-high 28 in 81-74 win over Oklahoma State.

■ St. John's hands Indiana its worst-ever NCAA tournament loss, 86-61.

■ Maryland sets school record in 75-63 win over Creighton.

WEST REGIONAL

■ No. 1-seeded Connecticut jumps out early, cruises over New Mexico, 78-56.

■ Iowa closes with 23-6 run in 82-72 win over Arkansas.

■ Florida goes to overtime to finally put away Weber State, 82-74.

THE TOURNAMENT TRAIL: HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

Falls earns title

19th-straight win sends Bulldogs to regionals

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — In a rough-and-tumble rubber match between two old rivals, Olmsted Falls nipped Rocky River Saturday night in a thriller that took an overtime period to settle.

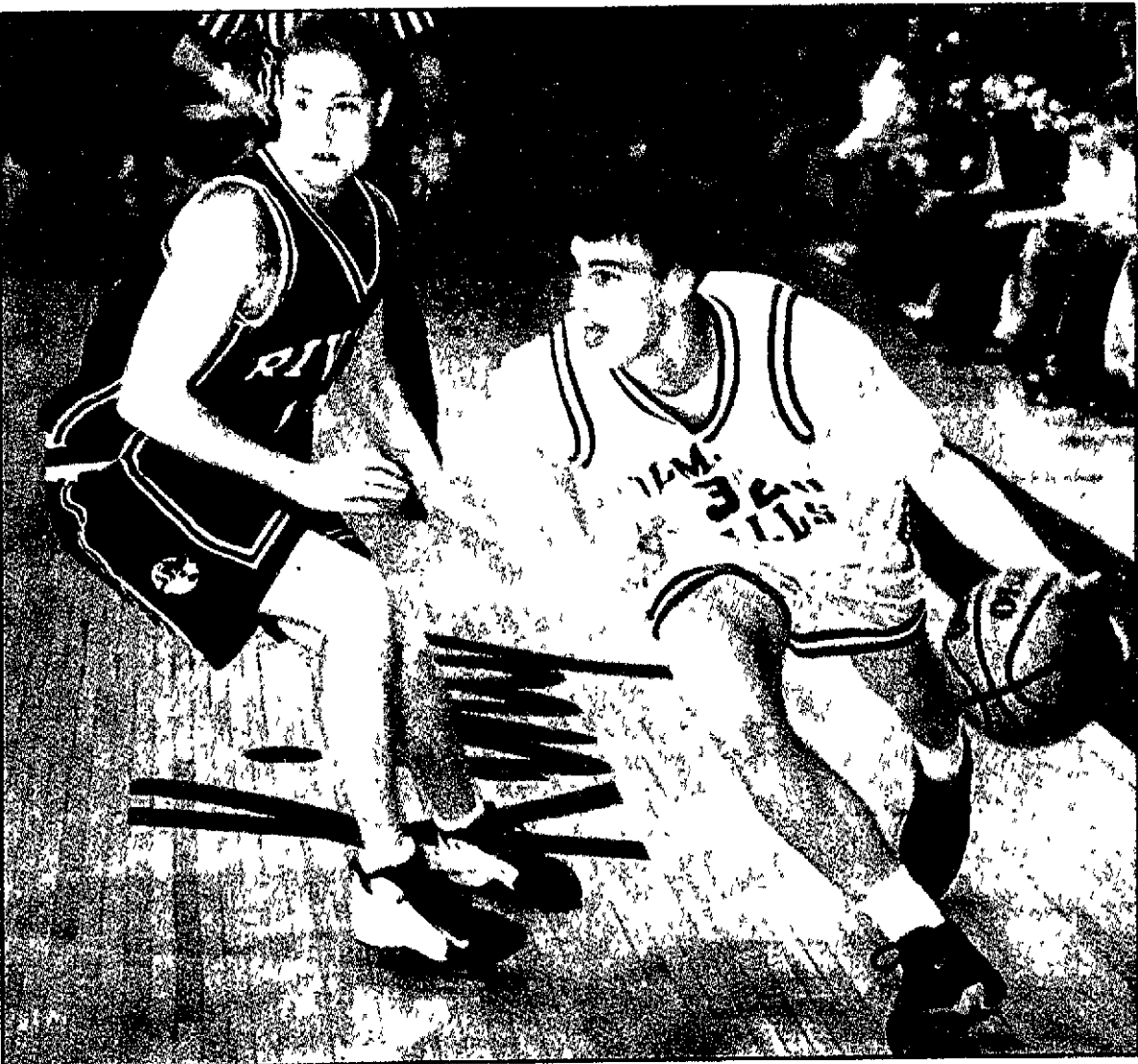
With a 71-68 victory — their 19th in a row — the Bulldogs (21-2) won their sixth Division II district championship of the 1990s, their fourth in the past five years.

They're headed for a regional semifinal game against Columbus Beechcroft Wednesday night at Bowling Green State University. Rocky River goes home 18-6.

"I'll say this, it was entertaining," said Bulldog coach Pat Donohue. "It was definitely worth the five bucks the fans paid to see it."

"It was one of those see-saw games where I never felt comfortable when we had the lead. You knew it was going to come right down to the end."

To the end and beyond, thanks to a 3-point by River's John Caruso with a second and a half to play that sent the game into overtime.



STEVE MANHEIM / CHRONICLE

ZEROING IN: Olmsted Falls' Sean Radigan (32) drives down court past Rocky River's Jeff Peate in Saturday's Division II district championship game.

It was close most of the way. Falls led 30-29 at the half, the teams were tied at 44 after three quarters and the Bulldogs moved to a 60-55 lead with 1:31 left in regulation.

It was white-knuckle basketball the rest of the way.

The Pirates' Dave Miller hit two foul shots at 1:10 to make it 60-57. After Falls threw up one

of its 10 bricks from the foul line at 56 seconds, River took a timeout with 38.8 seconds left to set up a play.

But the Pirates turned the ball over with 15.5 seconds to play and sent Falls back to the foul line with 13.6 seconds left.

Another foul shot, another brick.

Miller came down with the

rebound, River took another timeout at 7.5 seconds and set up a 3-point shot for either Caruso or Jeff Peate. It turned out to be Caruso and his shot from 'way beyond the arc was perfect just before the buzzer.

Falls junior Manzie Williams (five points) and sophomore

See **FALLS**, D7

Cordero leading DH race

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — Will Cordero is battling Richie Sexson for the designated hitter spot in the Indians' lineup this season. Manager Mike Hargrove knows it. Sexson knows it. And Cordero knows it — even if he won't admit it.

"I don't look at it that way," said Cordero. "I'm not battling Sexson. We're on the same team. When we go into other parks, we're battling our opponent. That's the way I look at it."

Still, if Cordero, who was acquired in the offseason as an insurance policy, makes the roster, Sexson most likely won't be

See **INDIANS**, D8

Lewis, Holyfield fight to draw

Ed Schuyler Jr.
Associated Press

NEW YORK — It turned out Evander Holyfield wasn't telling the truth, but the 36-year-old IBF-WBA heavyweight champion escaped with a loudly booed draw against Lennox Lewis in Madison Square Garden on Saturday night.

Holyfield said Lewis would be knocked out in the third round

See **FIGHT**, D9

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